



Water to Fuel

German company has made a machine that could convert water and carbon dioxide into liquid hydrocarbons <http://dgit.in/FuelWater>



3D-printed livers for sale

As 3D printing enters new areas, Organovo has got scientists excited as their 3D-printed livers are for sale now <http://dgit.in/3DLivers>

OnePlus One

One doesn't simply ignore this

It's been a month of big phone launches in India and the OnePlus One is a fitting culmination to it. The so called 2014 flagship killer is in India and we got a chance to take it through the motions before it went on sale. So without further ado, here's what we thought of the OnePlus One.

It belongs to the phablet category, so the size is expected, although you wonder if the bezel size on the top and bottom could have been cut some more. Nevertheless, the OnePlus One has a Sandstone finish on the back, which feels very premium.

The 5.5 inch display of course makes it big but add to that the 8.9 mm thickness and 162 grams weight and you have an overall bulky device. The OnePlus One is easily one of the biggest smartphones you can find right now.

The bigger a smartphone's display, lesser the margin for error. The 5.5 inch full-HD display does well under sunlight and though it is a little fingerprint intensive, we had no problems using this device outdoors. But even little things start sticking out at this size. The display is dull compared to other full-HD smartphones. Perhaps one of the trade-offs the company had to make in order to keep the obscenely low price tag.

We've read so much about the OnePlus One till now that the expectations from this phone were massive. The Snapdragon 801 chipset inside performs well on this phone. While it does get hot when put through resource intensive games, we could easily get 30 minutes of gaming out of this phone at a stretch.

Nevertheless, the 801 also ensures that the CM fork runs smoothly on the device. There were a few app crashes, but that was because of the unstable ROM and not the usual bad memory management issues. More on that later.

A major differentiating factor in the OnePlus One is in the fact that it comes with CyanogenMod 11S out of the box. This gives the phone a fresh new

feel compared to other Android smartphones. More importantly though, it a lot of super user privileges making the device a power user's dream. You can customise everything from the buttons to your icons, wallpapers and themes.

There's one problem though. CyanogenMod isn't the stablest ROM you can find. We got an update almost immediately after unboxing the

device, but there were some crashes that were most likely a result of an unstable ROM. As mentioned above, the processor performs well and memory management in KitKat is quite good, so the only reason we can think of is the ROM.

On a day of normal usage, with some light gaming, this device got us through the day with about 30-35% battery to spare. With our regular gaming, which is quite a bit, we still got through the day before the low battery warning flashed on the screen. Also note that the screen brightness on the phone was always on max.

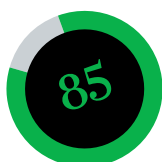
The 13 MP camera though was a disappointment. It may be enough for those who don't focus on photography a lot, it isn't really a stellar performer. Images taken under normal lighting seemed quite undersaturated and the auto-focus quite slow. The camera lacks exposure control, which often ends up blowing out objects in images. Also, the focus stutters a lot when lighting conditions are uneven.

It's hard to overlook the price of this smartphone, which makes this phone worth every penny. There are a lot of reviews that have overlooked the shortcomings of the phone because of the price factor. So, if you're planning to buy this phone then forget the reviews that you've read so far. The OnePlus One is definitely worth the price, especially if you want a phablet. But the phone does cut some corners for this, just like Xiaomi did for the Mi3 and will definitely do for the Mi4.

Prasid Banerjee



Price
₹24,999



Features	87
Performance.....	83
Design	79
Value	98

Specifications

Display: 5.5 inch 1080p;
Processor: 2.5 GHz
Qualcomm Snapdragon
801 quad-core; **Operating
System:** CyanogenMod
11S, Android 4.4.4 KitKat;
Camera: 13MP rear, 5MP
front; **Battery:** 3100 mAh;
Storage: 16/64 GB; **RAM:**
3 GB

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